

from a wide variety of sources that applied to my own life and kept them. At the same time, I took the parts that didn't fit what I wanted for my life and threw them away. Gradually, a personalized plan began to emerge that worked for my family and me.

As this happened, I felt myself becoming a happier and more empowered person. I began to see the positive effects again that financial independence could have, enabling me to pursue a variety of fulfilling paths at different stages in life.

I began to think about how to help others, each on their own individual journeys to FI. Each of you has personal strengths, weaknesses, past experiences, needs, and preferences. How could I help you reach financial independence quickly, empowering you to do whatever you desire with your life? How could I help you avoid the massive mistakes that I had made wasting a decade on a suboptimal financial path? How could I help you avoid driving yourself to the brink of depression by trying to live up to the standards of gurus whose philosophies, circumstances, strengths, and weaknesses did not match up exactly to your own?

While mimicking any single philosophy contributed to making financial and personal mistakes, I found truths in each of them. What if I started a podcast? I could interview a group of people who had